

## **TASK 5**

### **Part-A**

#### **Case Study**

Rohit, a college student, decided to sell his old phone on an online marketplace to earn some extra money. After posting the ad, he quickly got a message from a person who seemed genuinely interested. The buyer agreed to pay immediately through UPI and even sounded polite and convincing.

Soon, the buyer sent Rohit a QR code and told him to scan it to receive the payment. Rohit didn't think much about it and trusted the process. However, as soon as he scanned the code, instead of receiving money, ₹15,000 was deducted from his bank account. Shocked and confused, he tried calling the buyer, but the number was already switched off.

This kind of fraud is quite common. Scammers usually pretend to be genuine buyers or sellers, gain the victim's trust, and then create urgency. They send QR codes or payment requests, tricking people into approving transactions without realizing they are actually sending money.

Students, elderly people, and those who are not very familiar with digital payments are easy targets. The result is not just financial loss but also stress and a feeling of being cheated.

This incident shows how important it is to stay alert online. One should always remember that receiving money through UPI does not require scanning a QR code sent by strangers.

### **Part-B**

#### **Stay Safe Online – Prevention Checklist**

1. Never scan unknown QR codes to receive money — QR codes are mostly used to *pay*, not receive.

2. Always verify UPI requests before approving; check the name and amount carefully.
3. Do not share OTP, PIN, or bank details with anyone, even if they claim to be from the bank.
4. Avoid clicking on suspicious links sent via SMS, email, or social media.
5. Use strong and unique passwords for apps and enable two-factor authentication wherever possible.
6. Download apps only from trusted sources like official app stores (Play Store/App Store).
7. Be cautious while buying or selling online — don't trust people who create urgency or offer deals that seem too good to be true.
8. Regularly check bank statements and transaction history to spot any unusual activity early.
9. Log out from shared devices and avoid using public Wi-Fi for financial transactions.
10. Update your phone and apps regularly to stay protected from security vulnerabilities.

#### Reporting Cybercrime:

- National Cyber Crime Portal: <https://cybercrime.gov.in>
- Helpline Number: 1930